

**County Administration Workshop: August 28, 2026
1:00 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room**

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The Board declared there were no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Finance

1. Proposed Fee increases for District Attorney and Recreation

Matthew Eide, Finance Director, reviewed proposed fee changes. The Recreation/Fair fees were tabled for additional consideration and will return through the broader annual fee-review process. Finance proceeded with the District Attorney proposal because the office is preparing to implement Evidence.com. District Attorney fees were last adjusted in 2016; the proposed changes are generally about 20 percent and are intended to bring charges in line with the current cost of service. Obsolete video-cassette and audio-tape fees would be discontinued as records and evidence move to digital delivery.

The Board supported the District Attorney's modernization efforts and discussed reviewing departmental fees more regularly so future changes can be smaller and more predictable. Finance confirmed the proposal is cost-recovery, not revenue-generating. The Board requested a consistent Countywide format showing current fees, proposed fees and percentage changes. Finance outlined public notices for September 2 and 9, a public hearing at the September 16, 2026 Weekly Business Session, and an anticipated September 21 effective date if adopted. Without objection, the Board directed Finance to proceed with notice and bring the proposal forward for public hearing and formal action.

3. Board Business

a. Troutbeck Townhomes Middle Housing Land Division

The Board considered the Troutbeck Townhomes Middle Housing Land Division. The map had been available for public review in the Board's Office for several days. A minor wording or labeling revision was made to the drawings during the review period, which the Board stated did not materially alter the development. Commissioners noted the project would add needed housing. *Commissioner Richardson made a motion to approve the Troutbeck Townhomes Middle Housing Land Division. Commissioner Martin seconded. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.*

b. COCONUT - Automation Opportunity Sweep

The Board revisited the COCONUT automation opportunity proposal. Commissioners supported modernization and efficiency efforts generally but expressed concern about imposing an outside assessment on short-staffed departments that are already modernizing at their own pace. The Board emphasized the need for departmental buy-in, noted ongoing County AI-policy and modernization work, and raised concerns about protecting confidential or sensitive information. The Board expressed appreciation for the proposal but reached consensus that the County is not ready to proceed with COCONUT at this time and may revisit the concept later. No formal action was taken.

4. Other: (ORS 192.640(1)...Commissioners may introduce other matters for consideration by the entire Board)

No additional matters were introduced for consideration.

5. Additional Subject Matters from Commissioners/Announcements

Commissioner Richardson reported that seven departments had reached 100 percent employee-benefits enrollment: Emergency Management, Finance, Veterans Service Office, Legal Counsel, Surveyor, Treasurer and the Board of County Commissioners. Public Works was recognized for reaching 77 percent. Commissioner Martin reminded the public of the Whitehorse Park ribbon cutting Wednesday at 11:00 a.m. and recognized the Parks Department for the improvements. Chair Smith commended firefighters and the Sheriff's Office for their response to local fires and reminded the public that fire danger remains until fall rain arrives.

The meeting adjourned at 1:13 p.m.